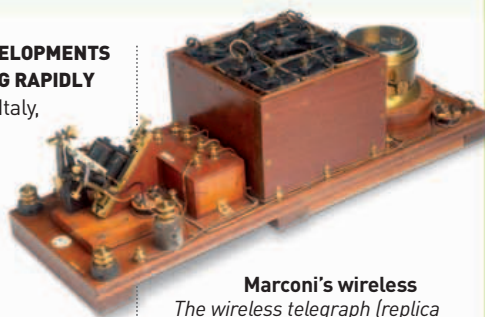


“ EVERY DAY SEES HUMANITY MORE **VICTORIOUS** IN THE STRUGGLE WITH **SPACE AND TIME.** ”

Guglielmo Marconi, Italian inventor

TECHNOLOGICAL DEVELOPMENTS WERE PROLIFERATING RAPIDLY

all over the world. In Italy, physicist and inventor **Guglielmo Marconi** (1874–1937) invented a **wireless telegraph**. In his initial experiments, using a telegraph key to operate a **transmitter**, he was able to send electromagnetic waves in bursts that corresponded to **Morse code**. He then used a transmitter to ring a bell that had been placed 30 ft (9 m) away. He worked on the **receiving antennae** and by the end of the year he could transmit a signal 1.5 miles (2.5 km). However, he found little enthusiasm for his work, so he went to Britain, where he patented



Marconi's wireless

The wireless telegraph (replica shown) developed by Guglielmo Marconi paved the way for the development of radio technology.

the device the following year, and laid the foundation for **radio technology**. Meanwhile, German physicist **Wilhelm Conrad Röntgen** (1845–1923) had been experimenting with electric currents and cathode-ray tubes. The outcome was a type of radiation that allowed objects to **appear transparent** on photographic plates. Röntgen called this **X-radiation**, an early version of the modern X-ray.

In **Korea**, the clash between Japanese and Chinese forces (see 1894) came to an end after the **Chinese defeat** in Pyongyang, and subsequent naval victories by the **Japanese fleet**. China sued for peace on February 12 and the resulting **Treaty of Shimonoseki**, which had involved Russian, French, and German intervention, forced China to give up the island of **Formosa** (modern Taiwan) to Japan, as well as the nearby Pescadores (Penghu) Islands. China also had to recognize **Korean independence**, open more ports to Japanese trade, and pay a large indemnity.



Early X-ray
One of the first X-ray photographs made by German professor Wilhelm Conrad Röntgen (1845–1923) captured a woman's hand with rings.

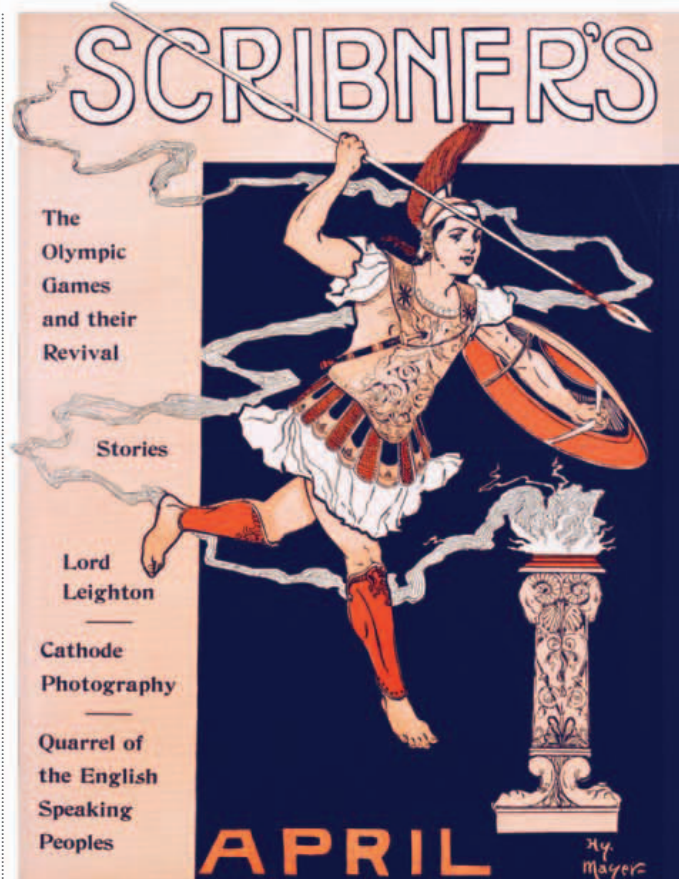


This scene from the Italian invasion of Abyssinia in 1896 shows the Abyssinian forces routing the Italian troops.

GREECE SAW THE MODERN REBIRTH OF THE ANCIENT

OLYMPIC GAMES, which was organized by an enthusiastic Frenchman, Baron **Pierre de Coubertin**. In 1890, he met **William Penny Brookes**, who had orchestrated a British Olympic Games in 1866. Coubertin and Brookes wanted to create an **international festival of modern sport**. After years of campaigning, Coubertin was finally able to organize the event in **Athens** from April 6–15. It was an enormous success—almost **300 contestants** competed in track and field, gymnastics, tennis, swimming, cycling, fencing, shooting, weightlifting, and wrestling, while **40,000 spectators** cheered them on. However, Brookes did not live to be present at the games, having died the previous year.

Meanwhile, **Italy** was trying to extend its reach in Africa with an invasion of the **Abyssinian Empire** (modern Ethiopia). Its previous attempt to annex the kingdom had ended in failure by 1889 (see 1872). Under the terms of the **Treaty of Uccialli**, Italy thought it had the right to establish a protectorate over **Abyssinia**, but this was contested. By 1895, the



Olympic revival

The cover illustration for the April edition of Scribner's Magazine celebrated the revival of the Olympic Games, being held in Athens, Greece. There were 43 events, in nine different sports.

1896 OLYMPIC GAMES

43 THE NUMBER OF **EVENTS**
14 THE NUMBER OF **COUNTRIES**
241 THE NUMBER OF **ATHLETES**

disagreement between Italy and Abyssinian emperor **Menelik II** (1844–1913) had turned into an armed conflict. The turning point was the **Battle of Adwa** on March 1, 1896, at which 80,000 Abyssinians defeated 20,000 Italian soldiers.

7,000
THE NUMBER OF **ITALIANS KILLED AT ADWA**

March 30 German **Rudolf Diesel** (1858–1913) patents the Diesel engine

April 17 Treaty of **Shimonoseki** marks end of China–Japan war

November 8 Wilhelm Conrad Röntgen discovers the X-ray

December 28 World's first moving picture film shown in Paris

March 1 Abyssinian army defeats Italians at **Battle of Adwa**

April Revival of the **Olympic Games** in Athens, Greece

May 18 US Supreme Court establishes a "separate but equal" doctrine between blacks and whites

June 4 Henry Ford's first automobile, the **Quadricycle**, completed

June 15 Earthquake and tsunami in Sankiru, Japan, kills 27,000 people

August 16 Discovery of gold along the **Klondike River**, northwest Canada, sparks a gold rush

September 22 Queen **Victoria** becomes longest reigning monarch in British history